

FACULTY OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCE

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATION STUDIES

TO	**:**	MR. SLYVESTER SILOH KAPONDERA
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THE CONCEPT AND CAUSES OF PLAGIARISM AMONG UNIVERSITY STUDENTS AND THE ROLES PLAYED BY THE LECTURERS, RESEARCHERS OR PUBLISHERS IN INFLUENCING PLAGIARISM

Elbow (1991) said "Textual ownership means these thoughts and phrasings are mine and not yours, and if you use them without attributing them to me, you have committed the worse academic sin of all, plagiarism". Therefore, with due respect to plagiarism, students are required to state their ideas with references. (Neville, 2007) defined referencing as the practice of acknowledging in your own writing the intellectual work of others, work that has been presented in some way into the public domain. Due to various reasons, students are fond of not using references in their academic texts which triggers plagiarism. Davis (2019) described plagiarism as the act of using someone else's words, phrases, ideas or work without giving appropriate credit. This definition highlights several aspects of plagiarism that students must avoid. However, lecturers, researchers or publishers also play their role which contribute to plagiarism and the below paragraphs will discuss the concept of plagiarism and its causes among university students as well as the roles of the lecturers and researchers or publishers.

First and foremost, the presence of information on digital platforms and various online based data websites triggers university students to practice plagiarism. The coming of the internet has influenced university students not to cite and give references on whatever they have read but rather they copy and paste the information they found on internet. According to Barlow (1994) defined internet as a new space for the creation of writing. Therefore, this definition concentrates on how internet have diluted the workability of research conducted by university students when writing various academic articles. However, (McCabe, 2003) claims that the incidence of plagiarism has risen with the increasing use of new technologies. He also added that the internet itself has not led to a significant rise in new cases of plagiarism, but the internet has provided space for those students already plagiarizing to increase their plagiaristic activities. This states that the internet creates a lazy mood among students as a result they cannot stop plagiarizing ideas.

Difficulties in academic writing is one also of the major causes of plagiarism in many academic grounds. This is an unintentional concept of plagiarism whereby most university students plagiarise without knowing the tertiary standard of academic writing. Therefore, (Pecorari, 2010) emphasized that if students are not aware of plagiarism, then it could be argued that they did not

intend to plagiarise but rather do not know that some kind of writing is not accepted in the university. In line with Pecorari, this plagiarism practice is due to lack of skills to summarise or paraphrase different sorts of ideas. Thereafter, by doing this, students prompt themselves to plagiarise.

Another cause of plagiarism among university students from different academic grounds is academic pressure. Student's academic pressure is contrary to the above academic writing in the way student's pressure is portrayed. This is an intentional concept of plagiarism because university students are already aware of what they are doing but due to pressure they tend to have no choice but rather to plagiarise. (Robinson & Reeves, 2019, p. 87) observe that the intense competition and high requirements that students face, drives them to engage in unethical practices such as conducting plagiarism. This leads students to become overwhelmed by their workload when they fail to cope up on due dates as they resort themselves to plagiarism to cope or meet deadlines due to intense academic pressure. Therefore, the fear of failure and pressure of being withdrawn from the academic grounds brings about the concept of plagiarism.

Furthermore, cultural differences and language barriers contributes to the causes of plagiarism. This is typically unintentional concept of the practice of plagiarism as students from different cultural backgrounds and of different language are not able to comprehend the semantic factor of the plagiarism content. According to Pecorari (2010) he stipulate that one of the major reasons of plagiarism by students that is not common and extensively discussed on the part of international students is the linguistic challenge. He also emphasizes that in multicultural academic settings, students from different linguistic and cultural backgrounds may struggle to understand academic conventions and citation practice. Therefore, when the barrier between the source language and the student's language of origin differs, there is likelihood of misinterpretation of the information referring to plagiarism. As this continues, it highly influences plagiarism.

Despite the concept and causes of plagiarism among university students, plagiarism is also influenced by the activities conducted by the lecturers, researchers or publishers. Therefore, financial pressure is regarded as one of the roles lecturers or researchers play in promoting the practice of plagiarism. The lecturers, researchers or publishers have the duty to produce quality work to university students that is well cited and proper use of referencing style. In contrary, they tend to do the opposite by only focusing on the monthly income without completely making sure

that students have understood the concepts of plagiarism. (Albrecht, et al., 2011) suggested that fraud can occur due to things like greed, lifestyle, debts, lack of income, financial loses and unexpected special needs. Meanwhile, this financial pressure enables mostly lecturers to prior financial activities over studies. This triggers plagiarism among university students.

The other role to wrap up this context is through working pressure. This is the concept of plagiarism that became unknown when lecturers and researchers are practicing it hence unintentionally due to various works they encountered. (Becker, et. al., 2006) discovered that lecturers or researchers sometimes also have other activities apart from conducting research. Therefore, due to this observation, it creates a room for them to provide information to the university students which is unauthorized and at the same time without acknowledging the owner of the data. Thereby, students are subjected to grasp the already plagiarized information and during academic works. They tend to give the information they know which is unethical and substandard. However, (Malgwi & Rakovski, 2009) together they emphasized that working pressure also has some consequences if it is not met. They also suggested that apart from losing a job, someone is in a possibility of losing financial support. Therefore, his habit triggers plagiarism practice as students are taught and research data which is not fairly credited.

In a summary, plagiarism among university students is a complex issue driven by a variety of circumstances. The presence of information on digital platforms and various online data websites, difficulties in academic writing, academic pressure as well as cultural differences and language barrier are the causes of plagiarism as discussed in the context. Meanwhile, the above paragraphs have also discussed about financial pressure and working pressure which are the roles of the lecturers, researchers or publishers in influencing the practice and use of plagiarism. Universities are able to address this issue by supporting academic integrity, establishing clear norms, and cultivating a culture of innovation and citation.

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